

The AI-Powered LinkedIn Carousel Playbook

A complete system for transforming Claude into your personal carousel design studio. No Canva. No design skills. Just structured prompts and brand-aligned output.

Adapted from **Yonathan Levy**

Original: Claude Skill that creates LinkedIn Carousels in Minutes

"Every slide comes out as a downloadable 1080x1080px PNG, ready to upload directly to LinkedIn."

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The Vision: AI-Powered LinkedIn Carousels

LinkedIn carousels have become one of the most powerful content formats for building authority, driving engagement, and growing your professional brand. They stop the scroll, deliver concentrated value in a swipeable format, and consistently outperform single-image posts in reach and saves. The challenge? Creating them has traditionally required design tools like Canva, hours of manual layout work, and a level of design skill that most professionals simply do not have.

This playbook introduces a paradigm shift: a Claude Skill that transforms a simple conversation with AI into a fully designed, brand-consistent LinkedIn carousel, complete with live swipeable previews and export-ready PNG files. No design degree required. No Canva subscription needed. Just your voice, your brand, and the power of structured prompting.

"Every slide comes out as a downloadable 1080x1080px PNG, ready to upload directly to LinkedIn. A live swipeable preview in the browser. A download panel with one button per slide plus a Download All option."

The Problem with Traditional Carousel Creation

Most professionals who create LinkedIn carousels follow a painfully slow workflow. They open Canva, pick a template, adjust colors, rewrite copy to fit text boxes, export each slide individually, and hope that the final result looks consistent. The entire process can take anywhere from 45 minutes to several hours per carousel. For creators who want to publish multiple times per week, this is unsustainable.

Beyond the time cost, there is a deeper problem: inconsistency. Each carousel made by hand carries subtle design variations in font placement, color usage, spacing, and visual hierarchy. Over time, your brand identity becomes fragmented. Your audience may not notice consciously, but they feel it. The Claude Skill solves this by encoding your entire brand system into a repeatable, deterministic process that produces pixel-perfect results every single time.

KEY TAKEAWAY: The Claude Skill replaces hours of manual design work with a structured conversation. You answer 10 brand questions once, and the system generates production-ready carousels in minutes, not hours.

Setting Up Your Claude Skill

A Claude Skill is a set of custom instructions that you add to your Claude profile. Once configured, Claude becomes a specialized system with deep knowledge of your brand, your design preferences, and your content strategy. Every time you ask it to create a carousel, it already knows your colors, fonts, tone, and audience. The setup takes less than five minutes, and the payoff is permanent.

The Setup Process

STEP 1: Open Claude and click your profile icon, then go to Customize

This takes you to the skill management area where all your custom configurations live.

STEP 2: Click Create Skill

This opens the skill creation interface with three key fields to fill.

STEP 3: Click Write Skill Instructions

This is where the magic happens. You will paste the complete skill instructions that define the entire design system.

STEP 4: Fill in Name, Description, and Instructions

The name is "LinkedIn Carousel Generator." The description summarizes what it does. The Instructions field contains the full system prompt.

STEP 5: Save, and you are done

From this point forward, Claude is your dedicated carousel design system.

The Skill Configuration Fields

Field	Value	Purpose
Name	LinkedIn Carousel Generator	Identifies the skill in your profile
Description	Generates a fully designed LinkedIn carousel from a topic or infographic.	Appears in the skill selection UI

Instructions	(Full system prompt - see Appendix)	The complete design system that Claude follows
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Table 1: Claude Skill configuration fields

KEY TAKEAWAY: Setup is a one-time investment of approximately five minutes. Once configured, you never need to repeat these steps. Every future carousel starts with a simple prompt and your pre-configured brand identity.

The Brand Alignment Protocol

Before the skill generates a single pixel of design, it initiates what the original author calls a "Brand Alignment Protocol." This is a structured onboarding interview consisting of ten carefully crafted questions. The purpose is not bureaucratic overhead. It is the foundation upon which every visual decision will be made. Your answers determine the color system, the typography, the slide count, the tone of voice, and the call to action.

"You must NEVER generate a carousel without first asking the questions in Step 1. Even if the user says 'make me a carousel about X,' your ONLY response is to ask the onboarding questions below. Do not generate any HTML, do not pick any defaults silently, do not skip questions. Ask first. Always."

The 10 Critical Questions

#	Question	Details / Examples
1	Who is this for?	Your name or brand name for cover and final slide
2	LinkedIn handle?	e.g. @yourname, shown in the creator badge
3	What is it about?	Topic, angle, or specific argument you want to make
4	Target audience?	e.g. founders, SDRs, CMOs, job seekers
5	Primary brand color?	Paste a hex code, or describe it for auto-selection
6	How many slides?	Punchy (6-8), Standard (9-12), or Deep-dive (13-16)
7	Tone?	Analytical / Tactical / Bold / Conversational / Storytelling / Minimal
8	Font vibe?	Editorial / Sharp / Warm / Bold / Clean modern

9	Logo or photo?	SVG logo, initials, or profile photo for the cover
10	Call to action?	Follow / Save / DM me / Comment / Visit link in bio

Table 2: The 10-Question Brand Alignment Protocol

The system waits for your answers before proceeding. It requires at minimum the topic, brand color, name, and handle. For any optional fields left blank, Claude will explicitly state the choice it makes on your behalf before building anything. This transparency ensures you always maintain creative control over the final output, even when leveraging AI automation.

KEY TAKEAWAY: The 10-question protocol is your brand insurance policy. It ensures that every carousel Claude produces is a faithful representation of your professional identity, not a generic template with your name slapped on it.

The Design System

What separates a professional carousel from an amateur one is not the content alone. It is the invisible architecture of design decisions: how colors relate to each other, how typography creates hierarchy, how spacing guides the eye, and how decorative elements add depth without distraction. The Claude Skill encodes all of this into a rigorous, deterministic design system that produces consistent results every time.

The 7-Token Color System

From your single primary brand color, the system derives a complete 7-token palette. This ensures harmonious color relationships across every slide, regardless of whether the background is light, dark, or gradient. The derivation follows mathematical rules based on color temperature and opacity modulation, eliminating guesswork and ensuring brand consistency at scale.

Token	Derivation	Usage
CORE	Your primary brand color	Numbers, icons, accent borders
CORE_SOFT	Primary at 12% opacity	Subtle fill backgrounds, tag chips
CORE_LIGHT	Primary lightened ~28%	Secondary accent on dark slides
CORE_DEEP	Primary darkened ~35%	Gradient anchor, high-contrast text
CANVAS	Tinted off-white	Light slide backgrounds (never pure white)
CANVAS_RULE	1-2 shades darker	Dividers, borders on light slides

INK	Near-black, brand-tempered	Dark slide backgrounds
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Table 3: The 7-token color system derived from a single brand color

The system also includes intelligent color temperature rules. Warm primaries like reds, oranges, and golds produce warmer canvas tones and ink colors. Cool primaries like blues, greens, and purples produce cooler, more clinical tones. The brand gradient used on cover and CTA slides is generated using a 150-degree diagonal gradient flowing from CORE_DEEP through CORE to CORE_LIGHT, with a subtle noise overlay at 3-5% opacity for depth.

The Typography System

Typography is the backbone of every carousel. The system offers seven curated font pairings, each optimized for a specific brand personality. Rather than overwhelming you with infinite choices, the system constrains the decision to a select menu of proven combinations used by top-tier publications and agencies worldwide.

Vibe	Font Pairing	Best For
Editorial / Premium	DM Serif Display + DM Sans	Finance, consulting, executive
Bold / Expressive	Fraunces + Outfit	Storytelling, culture, strong POV
Sharp / Technical	Space Grotesk 700 + 400	SaaS, product, data-driven
Warm / Human	Lora + Nunito Sans	Coaching, HR, personal brand
Clean / Modern	Plus Jakarta Sans	Startups, GTM, generalist
Authoritative	Libre Baskerville + Work Sans	Thought leadership, legal
Energetic / Loud	Syne 800 + Outfit	Marketing, growth, hot takes

Table 4: Curated font pairings by brand personality

Beyond font selection, the system enforces a strict typographic scale that ensures visual hierarchy across all slides. Cover headlines are set at 36-42px with tight letter-spacing. Slide headings use 26-30px. Body text is locked at 14px with generous line-height for readability. Eyebrow labels are rendered at 9px, fully uppercase with 2.5px letter-spacing for a premium editorial feel. Every size has been calibrated for maximum impact at the 1080x1080px export resolution.

Slide Format and Dimensions

Every carousel produced by the system follows a precise set of dimensional constraints optimized for LinkedIn. Slides are rendered at a 1:1 square aspect ratio. The HTML prototype is built at 540x540px

for efficient browser rendering, then exported at 1080x1080px via a 2x device scale factor. Each slide is a fully self-contained block with no UI chrome overlapping its content, ensuring clean PNG exports.

KEY TAKEAWAY: The design system is not a collection of suggestions. It is a deterministic set of rules that guarantee visual consistency. From your single brand color, the system derives seven harmonious tokens, selects appropriate typography, and enforces a rigid dimensional specification.

Slide Architecture

A great carousel is not a random collection of slides. It is a carefully architected narrative arc with a clear beginning, middle, and end. The Claude Skill enforces a proven slide sequence framework that has been optimized for LinkedIn engagement patterns, audience retention, and brand recall. Each slide type serves a specific psychological purpose in the reader's journey.

The Standard Slide Sequence

#	Type	Background	Purpose
1	Cover	Gradient	Bold hook, a specific debatable claim. Creator badge. No body text.
2	Problem / Context	INK (dark)	Frame the pain or mistake. Use strikethrough pills for the "old way."
3	Core Argument	CANVAS (light)	Your single most important idea, plainly stated.
4 to N-2	Content Slides	Alternate	Steps, stats, comparisons, frameworks. One idea per slide.
N-1	Summary / Recap	INK (dark)	3-5 bullet TL;DR. This is the highest-save slide type.
N	CTA	Gradient	Creator badge, CTA button, save prompt. No swipe arrow.

Table 5: The standard slide sequence framework

Required Elements on Every Slide

Regardless of slide type, every single slide in the carousel includes three mandatory UI elements that create a polished, professional experience. These elements are not decorative. They serve specific functional purposes that improve readability, navigation, and conversion.

Element	Position	Specification
Slide Counter	Bottom-left	01 / 10 format. Zero-padded, light weight. Anchors the reader and reinforces LinkedIn's native page numbering pattern.
Swipe Arrow	Right edge	SVG chevron on all slides except the last. Removed on the final slide to signal completion.
Save Prompt	CTA slide only	Bookmark icon + "Save this post" text at bottom-right. Activates on the final slide only.

Table 6: Mandatory UI elements across all slides

Content Component Library

Beyond the mandatory UI elements, the system includes a library of reusable content components that can be composed on any slide. Each component is designed for maximum visual impact and information density. The skill selects the appropriate component based on the content type you provide, whether it is a statistic, a comparison, a numbered list, or a pull quote.

Component	Visual Format	Purpose
Eyebrow Tag	9px uppercase label	Provides context category above slide content
Creator Badge	Avatar + name + handle	Anchors authorship on cover and CTA slides
Stat Callout Block	Large number + label	Sculpts data into a visual focal point
Numbered Insight Row	Big number + title + detail	Presents sequential insights with visual hierarchy
Before / After Comparison	Split grid layout	Contrasts the old way vs. new way side by side
Pull Quote	Large italic text + accent line	Stands alone as a standalone quote slide
Strikethrough Pill	Inline crossed-out text	Highlights the broken "old way" in context framing
Feature / Benefit Row	Emoji + label + description	Lists features with icons in a compact format
CTA Button	Centered pill button	Drives action on the final slide only

Table 7: Content component library for slide composition

KEY TAKEAWAY: Every carousel follows a proven narrative arc: Hook with a bold claim on the cover, build tension through the problem slide, deliver your core argument, support it with content slides, summarize the key takeaways, and close with a clear call to action. This structure has been optimized for LinkedIn's engagement algorithms and audience retention patterns.

Visual Design Language

The difference between a carousel that looks "designed" and one that looks "templated" lies in the subtle art of visual design language. The Claude Skill encodes a sophisticated system of decorative elements that add depth, texture, and visual interest without competing with the content. These elements are applied automatically based on the slide's background type, ensuring a cohesive visual rhythm throughout the entire carousel.

Decorative Design Elements

Every slide must include at least one decorative element to avoid a flat, plain appearance. The system provides three categories of decorative elements, each mapped to a specific background type. This is not optional. It is a mandatory design rule that ensures every carousel produced has visual depth and professional polish.

Background	Element	Specification
Light Slides	Large soft circle (top-right)	260px circle at 6% opacity creates depth
Light Slides	Smaller accent circle	100px circle at 4% opacity for layered feel
Dark Slides	Radial dot grid	1px dots at 3.5% opacity, 22px spacing
Dark Slides	Tinted circle	300px circle at 8% opacity for ambient glow
Gradient Slides	Concentric rings	Three rings at 7% opacity, centered

Table 8: Decorative design elements by background type

Visual Rhythm: Alternating Backgrounds

The system alternates between CANVAS (light) and INK (dark) backgrounds to create visual rhythm as the reader swipes through the carousel. This alternation serves a critical psychological function: it breaks the monotony of identical backgrounds, signals transitions between content sections, and creates a sense of progress. Gradient backgrounds are reserved exclusively for the cover and CTA slides, making them feel distinct and premium compared to the content slides in between.

The Before/After comparison component deserves special attention. It uses a two-column grid layout where the "Before" column uses a subtle grey background with muted text, and the "After" column uses the brand's CORE_SOFT fill with a CORE-colored border. The visual contrast between the two columns instantly communicates transformation and improvement, making it one of the most effective components for thought leadership content on LinkedIn.

KEY TAKEAWAY: Visual design language is the invisible thread that ties a carousel together. Decorative elements, background alternation, and component styling work in concert to create a premium, cohesive experience that distinguishes your content from the generic templates flooding LinkedIn feeds.

Technical Implementation

Understanding the technical architecture behind the Claude Skill gives you the power to customize, extend, and troubleshoot your carousel generation workflow. The system is built entirely on web technologies: HTML for structure, CSS for styling, and JavaScript for interactivity. The output is a self-contained HTML file with embedded swipe functionality, a LinkedIn-style preview frame, and a PNG download panel powered by html2canvas.

The LinkedIn Preview Frame

The carousel is presented inside a LinkedIn-style document post frame that mimics the actual LinkedIn user experience. This frame is exactly 540px wide and includes a header with avatar and creator name, a swipeable viewport for the slides, dot indicators that show progress, a page label displaying "Slide X of N," and an action bar with LinkedIn-style engagement icons. This preview frame allows you to evaluate exactly how your carousel will appear to LinkedIn users before exporting.

Browser-Based PNG Export

The download panel uses html2canvas to capture each individual slide at 2x resolution, producing 1080x1080px PNG files that are ready for direct upload to LinkedIn. The system provides individual download buttons for each slide as well as a "Download All" option. The capture process temporarily hides the frame chrome to ensure only the slide content is captured, then restores the frame after the screenshot is complete. This approach eliminates the need for Python, Playwright, or any server-side rendering tools.

Swipe and Drag Interactivity

The carousel supports both mouse drag and touch swipe navigation, matching the behavior users expect from LinkedIn's native document viewer. The JavaScript implementation tracks drag distance and applies a threshold of 50 pixels to determine whether to advance or retreat. Transitions use a cubic bezier easing function for a natural, fluid feel. The dot indicators and page label update in real-time to reflect the current slide position, providing clear wayfinding throughout the experience.

KEY TAKEAWAY: The entire system runs in the browser. No server, no API, no external tools. Claude generates a self-contained HTML file with everything embedded: styles, interactivity, and export functionality. You simply open the file in any modern browser and start swiping.

Your Action Playbook

Theory without action is entertainment. This final chapter transforms everything covered in this playbook into a concrete, step-by-step action plan. Follow these sequences in order, and you will have your first AI-generated LinkedIn carousel ready to publish within the next 30 minutes.

Phase 1: Brand Preparation (10 Minutes)

Identify your primary brand color

Find the hex code of the color that best represents your brand. If you do not have one, pick a color that evokes the emotion you want your audience to associate with your content.

Define your target audience

Write a one-sentence description of who you are creating content for. Be specific: "B2B SaaS founders with 10-50 employees who struggle with hiring" is better than "business people."

Choose your font vibe

Review the seven font pairings in Chapter 4 and select the one that best matches your brand personality. When in doubt, "Clean / Modern" (Plus Jakarta Sans) works for virtually any professional context.

Prepare your call to action

Decide what you want readers to do after seeing your carousel. "Follow for weekly insights" is effective for audience growth. "DM me" works for lead generation.

Phase 2: Skill Configuration (5 Minutes)

Configure the Claude Skill

Follow the five-step setup process from Chapter 2. Paste the complete skill instructions. Save the configuration.

Test with a simple topic

Start with a topic you know well. Answer all 10 brand alignment questions carefully. Review the output for accuracy and visual quality.

Iterate on your brand answers

If the first carousel does not feel right, adjust your brand alignment answers. The tone, font vibe, and slide count are the most impactful levers.

Phase 3: Production and Publishing (15 Minutes)

Open the HTML preview in your browser

Double-click the HTML file Claude generated. Swipe through all slides to verify content accuracy and visual quality.

Download all slides as PNGs

Use the download panel at the bottom of the preview. Click "Download All" to save every slide as a 1080x1080px PNG file.

Upload to LinkedIn

Go to LinkedIn, create a new post, select "Add a document," and upload all PNGs in order. Write a caption that expands on the carousel content.

Engage with early responses

Reply to the first comments within the first hour. Ask a question in your caption to boost engagement. Pin a comment with additional context.

"You answer 10 questions once, and the system generates production-ready carousels in minutes. No design degree required. No Canva subscription needed. Just your voice, your brand, and the power of structured prompting."